

5 questions to ask any coach before you pay

Ask them out loud, before any money moves. Ask me too.

"asan ang advice???"

A comment on r/phinvest about advisors who only teach you to pay premiums or sell you a policy. 72 upvotes.

The test behind all five: a sales pitch ends with their product. Real advice ends with **your numbers**.

1 "Show me one business you helped. What did its net income do, and over how long?"

GOOD ANSWER: a net income figure, a time period, and a business you could look up or ask about.

WALK AWAY IF: you only hear sales, followers, "students", or "life-changing".

2 "What will I have in my hands by the end of month two?"

GOOD ANSWER: things you can hold up. A breakeven number. A weekly P&L. A separate account.

WALK AWAY IF: the answer is a feeling: "clarity", "mindset", "you'll be a new person".

3 "If I do the work and it does not work, what happens? Put it in writing."

GOOD ANSWER: exact terms, with a date and a condition you can check.

WALK AWAY IF: "results vary", or a guarantee that only applies if you recruit someone.

4 "Do you earn anything from what you tell me to buy?"

GOOD ANSWER: a straight yes or no, and a list of what they earn from.

WALK AWAY IF: every lesson ends with a policy, a package, a franchise, or a "partner" product.

5 "Will you look at my breakeven, my net income, and my own salary before you advise me?"

GOOD ANSWER: yes, and they ask for your numbers in the first session.

WALK AWAY IF: they give you a plan before they have seen a single figure from your business.

IF YOU ASK ME

1. My own company, ARB Pharmaceutical, made ₱200K in net income in its first three months. One e-commerce client went from ₱1M a month in net income to ₱6.2M a month within six months.
2. In The Circle: your breakeven and a running profit account.
3. If by the end of month two we cannot show you both, you get the full fee back. If you have not added at least ₱500K in net income by month six, I keep working with you free until you do.

Keep this page. Use it on anyone who asks you for money to fix your business, including me.